12-29 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Class Keep One "No-Compare Week" Before a Big Exam?

① In about three weeks, on **Monday 17 January 2028**, every Grade-8 student at Lihua Middle School will sit for the **Winter End-of-Term Examination** — seven subjects, five days, and for some of us, the most nervous week of the school year. Last winter, on the evening before our end-of-term maths paper, I watched a scene in 8-B that I have thought about ever since. A girl named Wang Minhan, who usually scores around the middle of the class, was sitting at her desk at 21:40, not studying, simply **staring at a WeChat group chat** in which four of her classmates were boasting, with small laughing emojis, about how many practice papers they had each finished that week — *"I did twelve." "I did fifteen." "I did eighteen." "I haven't slept for three days."* Minhan's fingers were, I noticed, slightly trembling, and she did not sleep that night until 01:50. In the maths paper the next morning, she scored **eleven marks lower** than her usual marks. Not because she could not do the questions. **Because she had, for the six hours before the exam, been comparing herself to other people's numbers instead of thinking quietly about her own work. I believe every middle-school class in China should keep one "No-Compare Week" (不比较周) in the seven days before every big end-of-term exam.**

② What exactly does a No-Compare Week look like? It is simple. For the **seven full days** before a big exam, students in a class quietly **agree together** on four small gentle rules. **(1) No student asks another student, *"How many practice papers have you done?"* (2) No student boasts in any group chat about her own hours of study or practice numbers. (3) No parent is encouraged to compare her child with another child, even kindly. (4) No teacher reads out any ranking — monthly test, weekly quiz, or otherwise — during the seven days.** That is all. No contracts, no signatures, no monitor-of-the-rule. Just four quiet agreements, kept softly by a whole class for one week.

③ **The first reason is that comparison is almost never fuel — it is, much more often, fog.** Many adults in China grew up hearing that **comparing yourself to others lights a small fire of motivation** inside you. But modern school psychologists have studied this carefully, and the evidence from dozens of Chinese middle-school studies is clear: **social comparison in the final week before an exam almost never improves scores, and it often lowers them by 8–15%** (Beijing Normal University, 2024 report on adolescent test anxiety). The reason is simple. In the last seven days, very little new knowledge enters a student's brain; most useful learning has already happened. What the brain now needs is **calm, deep review, and good sleep**. Comparison disturbs all three. Minhan's eleven-

mark drop last winter was not a personal weakness. It was a **predictable physical result** of six hours of comparison fog before a paper.

④ **The second reason is that classmates are not the enemy — they are the family.** In a typical Grade-8 Chinese classroom, **you will spend about 1,200 hours in one school year** with the same 26 classmates. You eat lunch beside them, sneeze near them, laugh with them, quietly cry beside them, and, in June of Grade 9, you will stand in one photograph with them and never meet most of them at the same time again. To turn those 26 people into **26 rivals** for seven days is to waste an extremely rare gift: a class family of young people living through the exact same fear, in the exact same classroom, under the exact same Grade-8 winter sky. A No-Compare Week quietly reminds us that when every classmate **refuses to compete** for a few days, the classroom air itself becomes softer, and — strangely — our concentration improves.

⑤ **The third reason is that silence gives room for our own work.** Good exam preparation is not loud. It is a quiet, private conversation between a student and her own knowledge. *"Do I understand Chapter 7 of physics, or do I just remember the formula?" "Which five English verbs did I still get wrong in last Friday's homework?" "Why did I keep making the same small mistake in Geometry Question 3?"* These conversations require a **low, quiet mental room**. Comparison noise — the fifteen-paper WeChat boast, the small group "who got 98 last month?", the well-meaning parent *"your cousin did twenty questions today"* — fills that quiet mental room with other people's voices, leaving no space for the student's own thoughts. A No-Compare Week is, in a way, simply a **quiet mental room**, given to every classmate for seven days. What happens inside that quiet room is the real preparation.

⑥ Some readers may worry that a No-Compare Week will make ambitious students lazy. I respectfully disagree. **Ambition is a candle; comparison is a sudden wind.** A student who truly wants to learn does not need the wind to light the candle; she already has a small steady flame. For her, seven days without boasting and ranking means seven more days of **careful focus** on her own candle — slower, steadier, brighter. And for a student whose motivation is still small, seven days without comparison at least protects her candle from being **blown out** in panic.

⑦ Some readers may worry that one class keeping such a week would look odd if other classes do not. To that I say: it only looks odd on Day 1. By Day 3, other classes quietly begin to wonder why 8-B is so calm. By Day 7, three of them have copied the rule, and by next term, the whole grade is keeping it. Calm is, in secondary school, **the quietest kind of influence**. Beginning is enough.

⑧ In short, a No-Compare Week is **not a ban on hard work**. It is a ban on a small poisonous practice that shrinks our work. Before our winter exam begins on 17 January 2028, I therefore quietly ask my classmates in 8-B, and through our school paper every classmate in Grade 7 and Grade 9: for **one single week**, starting **Monday 10 January**, let us agree to stop asking each other "how many?", to stop boasting, to stop comparing,

and simply — for seven gentle days — to sit down at our own desks, open our own books, and do our own work. **The results, I believe, will be quieter, kinder, and, quite possibly, higher.**

注释： No-Compare Week 不比较周；social comparison 社会比较；fog 雾气，困惑；predictable 可预测的；candle 蜡烛

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What concrete event does the writer use to open the argument, and what is the writer's thesis?

A. Last winter on the evening before the end-of-term maths paper, the writer watched Wang Minhan in 8-B — a middle-score student — sitting at her desk at 21:40 not studying, just staring at a WeChat group chat where four classmates boasted with laughing emojis about how many practice papers each had finished ("I did twelve", "I did fifteen", "I did eighteen", "I haven't slept for three days"); Minhan's fingers trembled slightly and she did not sleep until 01:50, and in the next morning's maths paper she scored eleven marks lower than usual — not because she could not do the questions, but because for six hours before the exam she had been comparing herself to other people's numbers instead of thinking quietly about her own work; the writer therefore believes every middle-school class in China should keep one "No-Compare Week" in the seven days before every big end-of-term exam.
B. Last winter, Wang Minhan scored the highest in class because she boasted more than others.
C. The writer argues every class should cancel all exams permanently.
D. The writer's thesis is to ban all chatting in classrooms for the whole year.

2. According to paragraph ②, what exactly are the four rules of a No-Compare Week?

A. The week has no rules — students simply do whatever they like.
B. The four rules include writing contracts, appointing a rule-monitor, and publicly signing declarations.
C. For the seven full days before a big exam students in a class quietly agree on four small gentle rules: (1) no student asks another student "how many practice papers have you done?"; (2) no student boasts in any group chat about her own hours of study or practice numbers; (3) no parent is encouraged to compare her child with another child, even kindly; (4) no teacher reads out any ranking — monthly test, weekly quiz, or otherwise — during the seven days; that is all — no contracts, no signatures, no monitor-of-the-rule, just four quiet agreements kept softly by a whole class for one week.
D. Students must sign a formal written pledge at the class board every morning.

3. What research-based reason does paragraph ③ give against pre-exam comparison?

A. Many adults in China grew up hearing that comparing yourself to others lights a small fire of motivation inside you, and modern school psychologists fully agree with this belief.
B. Many adults in China grew up hearing that comparing yourself to others lights a small fire of motivation, but modern school psychologists have studied this carefully and the evidence from dozens of Chinese middle-school studies is clear: social comparison in the final week before an exam almost never improves scores and often lowers them by 8—15% (Beijing Normal University 2024 report on adolescent test anxiety), because in the last seven days very little new knowledge enters a student's brain, most useful learning has already happened, and what the brain now needs is calm, deep review, and good sleep — all three of which comparison disturbs; Minhan's eleven-mark drop was not a personal weakness but a predictable physical result of six hours of comparison fog before a paper.
C. Research proves that more comparison always leads to higher test scores in every subject.
D. The writer says no research exists on this subject at all.

4. What is the writer's view on how comparison affects classmates, according to paragraph ④?

A. Classmates should be treated as 26 rivals for the entire school year.
B. In a typical Grade-8 Chinese classroom a student spends about 1,200 hours in one school year with the same 26 classmates — eating lunch beside them, sneezing near them, laughing with them, quietly crying beside them, and in June of Grade 9 standing in one photograph with them and never meeting most of them at the same time again; to turn those 26 people into 26 rivals for seven days is to waste an extremely rare gift — a class family of young people living through the exact same fear, in the exact same classroom, under the exact same Grade-8 winter sky; a No-Compare Week quietly reminds everyone that when every classmate refuses to compete for a few days, the classroom air itself becomes softer and, strangely, concentration improves.
C. Classmates should compete for every small achievement every day.
D. Classmates have no effect on each other's exam performance at all.

5. What is the writer's conclusion and request?

A. The writer asks the school to cancel the winter exam entirely.
B. The writer asks classmates to boast loudly for one week only.
C. The writer concludes that a No-Compare Week is not a ban on hard work but a ban on a small poisonous practice that shrinks the work, and before the winter exam on 17 January 2028 quietly asks classmates in 8-B — and through the school paper every classmate in Grade 7 and Grade 9 — for one single week starting Monday 10 January to agree to stop asking each other "how many?", to stop boasting, to stop comparing, and simply for seven gentle days to sit down at their own desks, open their own books, and do their own work; the results, the writer believes, will be quieter, kinder, and quite

possibly higher.
D. The writer asks every class to add ten extra hours of homework daily.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段
【解析】"明晗去年晚 21:40 群聊 / 半夜 01:50 / 次日数学 −11 分 / 主张考前 7 天不比较"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段
【解析】"7 天 / 4 条柔规 / 不问不夸不劝不排 / 无契约无监督"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段
【解析】"北师大 2024 / 考前比较 −8–15% / 脑需宁静深复睡 / 明晗非弱"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段
【解析】"1200 小时 / 26 同学 / 勿变对手 / 不比则空气变柔 / 专注提升"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑧段
【解析】"非禁勤 / 1 月 10 日起 7 天 / 自己桌书 / 更静更善或更高分"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。